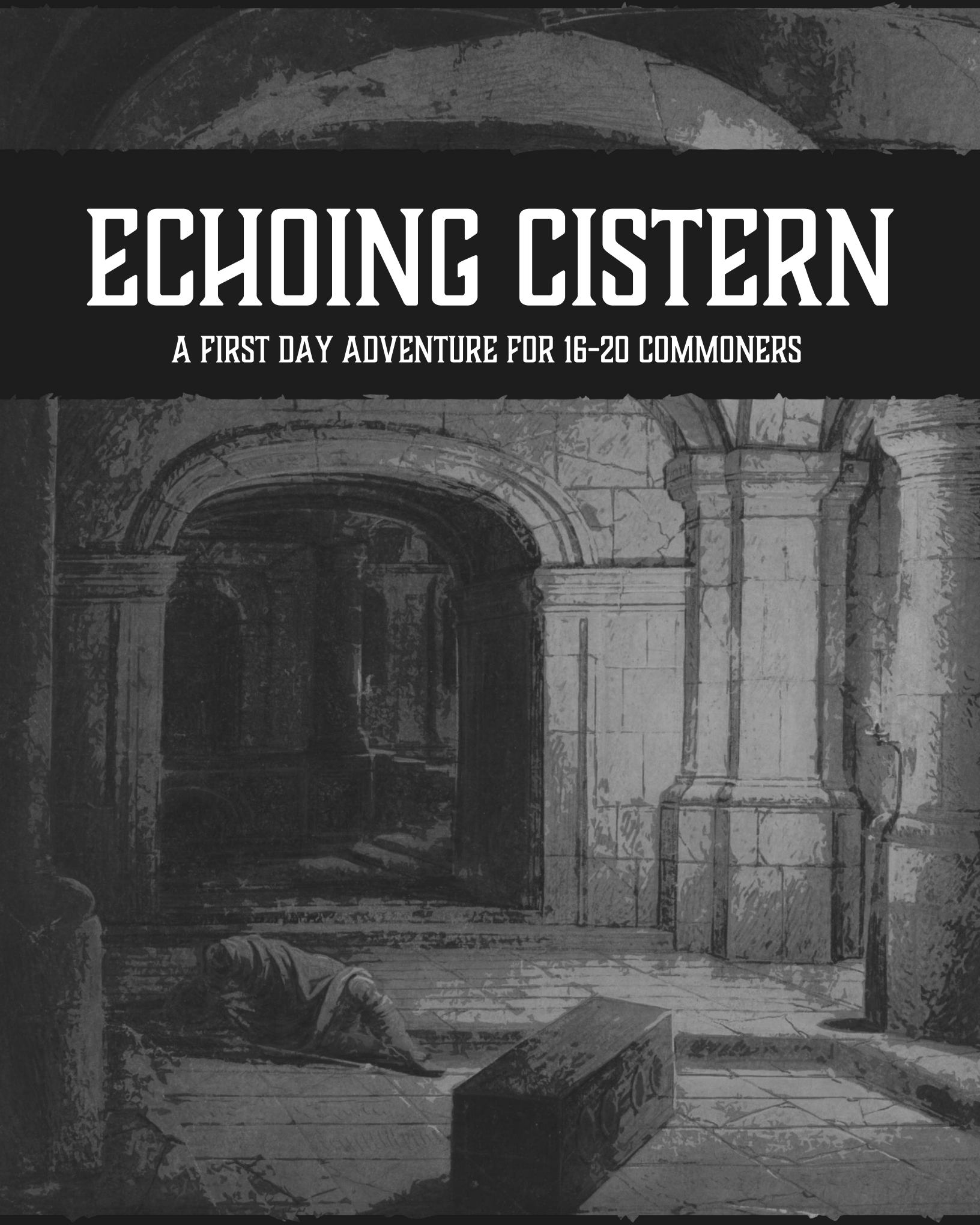
ECHOING CISTERN

A FIRST DAY ADVENTURE FOR 16-20 COMMONERS



ECHOING CISTERN

A First Day Adventure For 16-20 Commoners

A ship floats gently into a harbor, lit by the light of a full moon. Above it stands silhouetted a foreboding city of black stone. You were sent here to the Lacklands as punishment, yet after your accursed journey across the sea, it is with some relief that the city they call the Black Ring now towers before you.

You are the sole survivors of a voyage that bore fifty prisoners and half as many guards, a prison barge filled with refuse from the old realm: outcasts, thieves, disgraced nobles. A sickness - followed by a mutiny, followed by an uprising - left the guards dead, the rudder broken, and the barge at the mercy of the wind. It is only by the grace of the gods that it ushered you here.

It thus seems a cruel joke of fate that the ship, upon drifting into the harbor, lists from its course. Its barnacled figurehead, a weeping angel, turns away from the docks and towards the black cliffs. The ship appears drawn toward a massive black pipe, an outlet steadily pouring the filth of the city into the water below.

As it draws near, the rotting hull of the ship utters a groan and then a series of splintering snaps, testing and failing against the rocky shallows. It was taking on water already- it will soon be a gift to the sea.

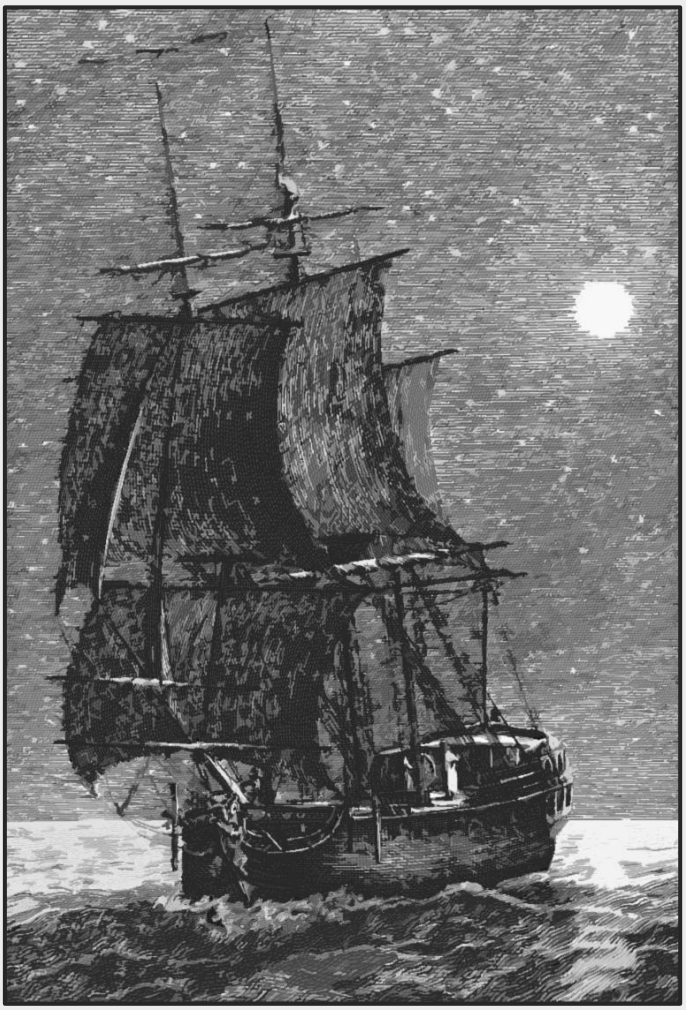
A plank is lowered toward the pipe. It is not the solid earth you hoped for, but it's still better than the beleaguered vessel you leave behind. There is but one thing to do now: **find the surface**.

HOSTILITY TIER 0

A First Day dungeon has a **hostility tier** of **0**. The target number for **explore** checks is **10**, and **random encounters** have a **threat rating** of **2d6 x 5**.

ADAPTING THIS DUNGEON

As you can probably tell from the intro, this First Day is intended to lead into an urban campaign, but there's no reason you have to stick to that premise! Perhaps the city is a desolate ruin, and the commoners will have to make their way into the wilderness. Perhaps there's no trace of it at all, but for this lonesome ruin. With a bit of creativity, you could even re-flavor this dungeon as a tainted natural spring, a series of tidal caves that once housed a pirate's hideout, or something else entirely to better suit the campaign you have in mind.



SPECIAL RULES

The Rats Guide It: A commoner with the PERCEPTION skill can observe that in the murky water below, swarms of small, dark creatures seem to be pressed against the ship's hull, guiding it towards the pipe. Their eyes glow yellow.

Prison Ship Crewmates: Any commoner of the **Soldier** social group or with any sort of naval **Past Life** was one of the guards, not one of the prisoners. The trials of the past weeks have mostly settled their differences with the prisoners- the ship needed a crew, after all.

The Guards' Equipment: After the uprising, most of the weapons were thrown overboard, but the commoners have reclaimed some of the belongings of the dead guards:

- 2 crude swords (d6, melee, confer **unguarded 2**)
- a solitary **lantern**
- a bottle of **lantern fuel**

PREPARING FOR THE FIRST DAY

This page goes over the basics of how to run a dungeon. The full rules can be found in the TRESPASSER rulebook. Player rules for exploration are in **Chapter IV: Exploration**, while guidance for the Judge on designing and running dungeons is in **Chapter XII: Expeditions**.

COMMONERS

During a First Day adventure, each player takes on between two and four random 0th-level characters called **commoners**. They don't become trespassers until they survive the perils of the First Day. Your players can use the provided commoner record sheet and the **generator found here** to quickly assemble their team.

MOBS

Mobs are an optional but highly recommended rule for running the First Day. Each player groups their set of commoners into one square during combat and takes a single turn with all of them. This makes encounters a lot easier to track. The optional rules for mobs are in **Chapter VI: Trespassers**.

DUNGEON ROUNDS & TURNS

The full rules on how to run a dungeon can be found in the TRESPASSER rulebook in **Chapter XII: Expeditions**. This is just a summary to help you get started.

DUNGEON ACTIONS

The party has a variety of dungeon actions they can take. The main one is the **explore** action, which they use to explore a new, adjoining space. See the **table reference** for the other ones.

TRACKING ROUNDS

The party can take three dungeon actions each round. Each time the party takes a **dungeon action**, like exploring a new room, or interacting with a feature of the dungeon, a mark it on a tracker. After every three actions, the round is over, and you need to do **dungeon upkeep**.

DUNGEON UPKEEP

Every three actions, the dungeon round ends and you take three steps:

- **Depletion**: Have players make **depletion checks** for their active light sources, rolling **1d6**. On a **1 or 2**, their light goes out.
- **Alarm**: Increase the dungeon's **alarm** value by **1** (it starts at 0).
- **Random Encounter**: Check for a **random encounter**, rolling a **d10**. If the result the same or less than the current **alarm**, they have a random encounter. Random encounters are listed at the end of this document.

READING A DUNGEON

The dungeon is divided up into a set of rooms. Rooms are discrete spaces that contain a number of details for the characters to discover. Some rooms have traps and encounters.

ROOMS DESCRIPTIONS

Rooms are listed by **number**, with a basic description under their name. Give this description when the party first enters, then describe a number of details equal to the number of successes they got on their **explore** check, shifting the spotlight as needed to focus on characters that succeeded.

The room's **details** are listed by **letter** underneath the basic description. They are ordered from most prominent to most obscure.

ROOM DETAILS

Each player makes an **explore** check of INTELLECT | PERCEPTION when they enter a new room, using their commoner with the best bonus. For each success, they learn one **detail** about the room. After exploring, if the players feel there might be more to discover in a room, they can take the **search** action to fully investigate, learning about any details they missed.

SIGNS

Signs are room details that give a bit of information about a connecting room. Discovering a sign will give a clue whether the next room contains a **room trap** or **encounter**.

ENCOUNTERS

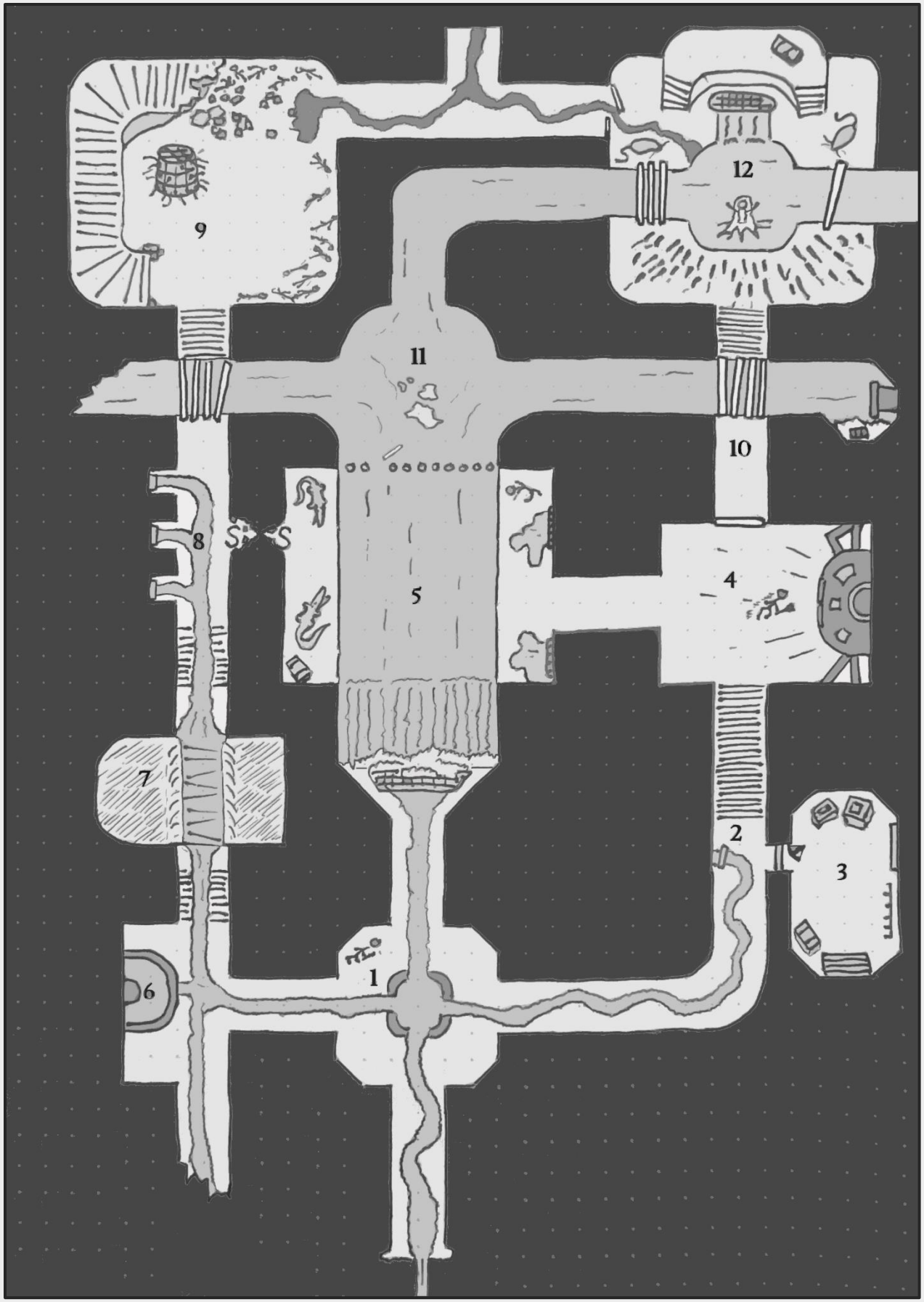
A room with an **encounter** is marked with an **(E)** by its name. When players try to explore into this space, they instead go into the encounter procedure, making an AGILITY | STEALTH **group check** instead of their normal explore check. The encounter procedure is explained in the rulebook under **Chapter XII: Expeditions**.

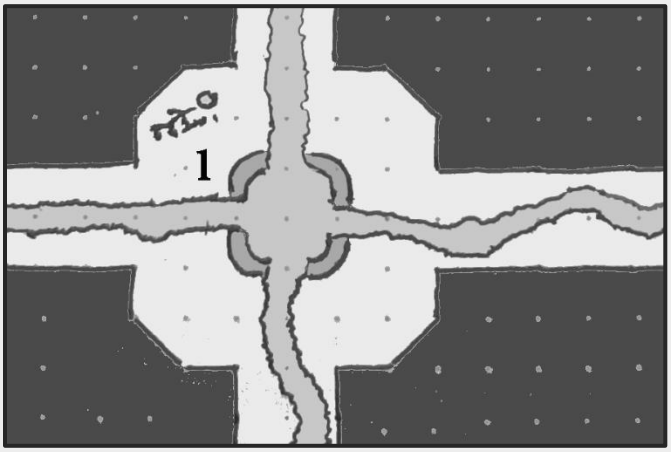
ROOM TRAPS

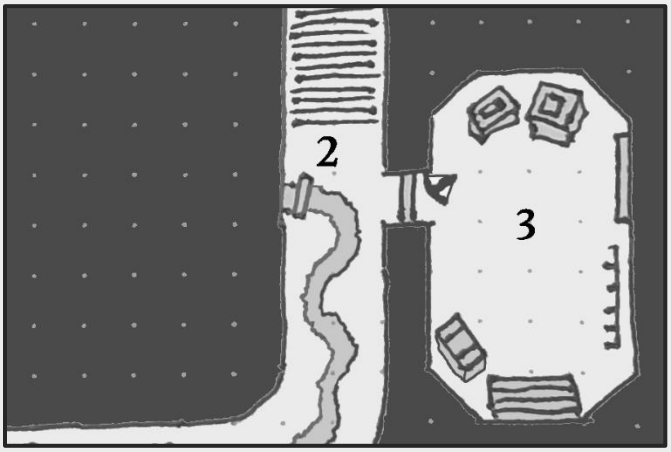
A room with a **room trap** is marked with a **(T)** by its name. When the party **explores** this room, they make their explore check to see if they spot the trap. If they get a number of successes equal or greater than the trap's **hidden** value, they can pivot to **disarm** or **interact** with it, or withdraw and **explore** in a different direction. If they fail to spot the trap, they spring it and must resolve the **trigger** effect. If they have found a **sign** of the trap in a previous room, the trap's **hidden** value is reduced by **1**.

DARKNESS

A room without light is marked with a **(D)** by its name. While the party is acting without light, they skip their explore checks, and Judge can add an extra **shadow** to any **dungeon action** checks they make. Enemies in darkness have the **shadowy** state, making them much more dangerous to fight.


12
9
11
10
8
5
4
7
2
3
6
1





1. SLIMY CROSSROADS (D,T)

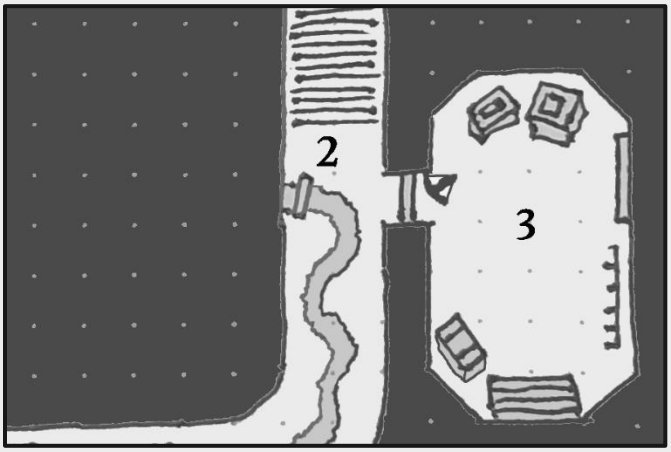
The entrance pipe leads north to a square chamber with rounded edges. Filthy water forms a deep well at its center, fed by streams running from west, north, and east, a tunnel leading each way.

- **A.** **Room Trap: Well of Filth. Hidden 2.** The water is too tainted to tell, but pool at the center of the room is very deep. If they party spot this trap, they don't need to disarm it; they can simply avoid the center of the room.
  - ✦ **Trigger:** One random commoner is pulled down into thick slime. The party must make a group check of MIGHT | ATHLETICS to pull them out.
  - ✦ **Effect:** On a group failure, the victim suffers **2d6** damage before being hauled back to the surface. If they survive, they retrieve something precious from the muck below: a **helm** (L,+1 AR,d8).
- **B.** **Corpse.** A corpse of a young woman is slumped against the corner. She's bleeding from her inner ears. She has a few possessions:
  - ✦ high boots (L,+1 AR,d8).
  - ✦ torch (d6)
  - ✦ dagger (d4, melee/missile 4, confer **bleeding 4**)
- **C.** **Ladder.** An iron ladder fastened to the wall terminates at the ceiling. The stone sealing the entrance shut looks younger than the surrounding stonework and is, disappointingly, completely unbreakable.
- **D.** **Sign: West.** There is an aromatic scent of incense coming from the western tunnel, as well as the squeaking and chittering of rats. Leads to **6**.
- **E.** **Sign: North.** The water flowing from the north is certainly the strongest current. The sound of rushing water can be heard further ahead.
- **F.** **Sign: East.** A small trickle flows from the eastern tunnel. It takes a bend north. Around the corner is flickering light.

2. EASTERN PASSAGE (D)

The eastward tunnel takes a bend to the north, where it becomes a set of slick stone stairs. The trickle of water stems from a small pipe on the western wall; there is a rusted metal door with a grate above it into the room beyond.

- **A.** **Detail Trap: Iron Door.** The thieves' trap is quite obvious: a crude crossbow in the grate above the door is poised to shoot down on anyone who disturbs it. Leads to **3**.
  - ✦ **Trigger:** A fool who tampers with the door without disarming the trap takes **1d8** damage.
- **B.** **Detail Trap: Plague Rat Pipe.** The trickle of water stems from a pipe on the left-hand wall, at head-height. There's an old box in there, within reach, but a pair of yellow eyes glimmer next to it.
  - ✦ A SPIRIT | NATURE check can disarm this trap, since it's just a rat.
  - ✦ **Effect:** The plague rat's bite deals **1d4** damage and confers **weak 4 (lasting).**
  - ✦ **Box:** The box contains a **potion of healing,** which restores 2d6 hit points to a commoner than imbibes it.
- **C.** **Sign: North.** A staircase leads north, lit by some flickering light. You hear the steady, laborious groan of a machine hard at work.
- **D.** **Sign: South.** The tunnel takes a bend to the west. The trickling of water and the whisper of the sea's breeze wafts further on.



3. HIGHBOOTS HIDEOUT (D)

A band of smugglers called the **Highboots** use the sewer to transport illicit goods. This appears to be one of their dens, an old workshop with a note board, a chest, a few empty weapon racks.

A. Crossbow. Once disarmed or sprung, the crossbow above the door can be removed and taken. There are bolts in a pouch hanging from a nail on the back of the door.

- crude crossbow (1d8, missile 10, two-handed, confer **bleeding 4)**

B. Chest. A large chest in the corner contains a few useful things:

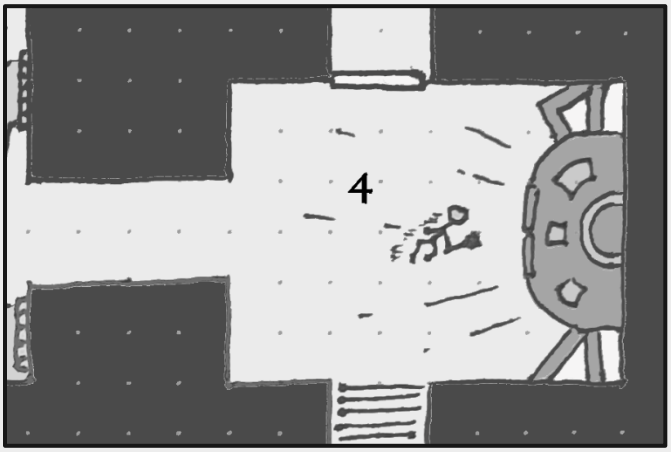
- rope (50') and grappling hook
- gloves (L,+0 AR, d8 AD)

C. Note Board. At the back of the room is a board where Highboots have nailed messages to each other. Among them are notes in the vulgar tongue to "follow the blood" and "don't forget to plug your ears." There's a box below that one that has a **tiny lump of wax** good for two sets of earplugs.

D. Torch. An unburned torch is firmly stuck in a sconce in the wall. It can be smashed out of place (14), but a **shadow** breaks the torch.

E. Campfire. A pile of ashes are positioned below a black metal grate in the ceiling. There's a **crude cooking set** here.





4. BOILER ROOM (T)

A long-neglected yet still somehow functional boiler dominates the eastern wall. The billowing flames below it cast the room in an orange light. The boiler is under a dangerous amount of pressure and rattles frightfully. A skeleton lies face-down in silhouette on the floor before it.

A. Room Trap: Exploding Boiler. Hidden 2. The boiler has filled the room with steam. It squeals and rattles as though fit to burst. If the party enter this room with a sign, they can wait out the first blast and send a commoner in to **disarm** it or **interact** with it somehow.

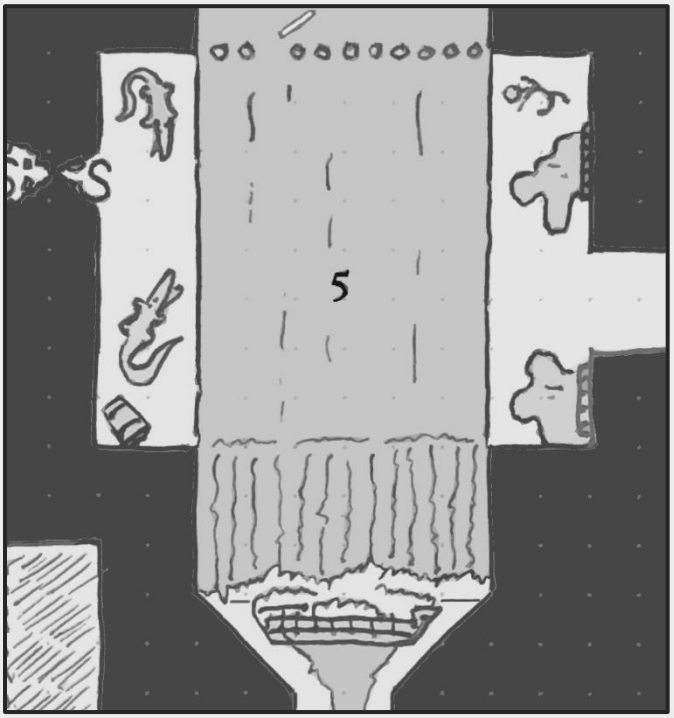
- **Trigger:** The party must a make a group check of AGILITY | ACROBATICS to dive out of the way as a blast of steam fills the room (each mob makes one roll, using their best bonus).
- **Effect:** On a group failure, a random commoner from each failing mob suffers 1d4 damage and is **blinded** (**lasting**).

B. Skeleton. The skeleton of some poor laborer is here. He is clutching:

- craftsman's hammer (as crude war hammer: d6, melee, confer **weak 2**)

C. Sign: West. The sound of roaring water emanates from the western exit.

D. Sign: North. A huge and imposing iron door, firmly locked. There are words etched into the stone beside it in the vulgar tongue. It says "Stay out! Cover your ears!" The door can be opened easily with the **key to the echoing cistern.** It can also be picked (16 | SLOW). It can be smashed apart but may fall off its hinges and crush someone. (14 | LOUD | HARMFUL). When the door is opened, one can see stone steps upward and hear the splashing of sewer water against **rotten planks**.





SICKLY CROCODILE — TR 10

- **Stalker 1**
- **HP:** 40
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 14
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +4

Large: This creature occupies a 2 x 2 area. It counts as a wall for line of sight and can resist forced movement by half.
Swimming: This creature can move through water at full speed.

(L) **SNAP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6). Drag 2.
Shadow: Confer **grappled 4**.

(H) **WRENCHING TWIST** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Base: Deal 7 damage (2d6).
Hit: Sweep 1. Confer **toppled 2**.

(M) **TAIL SLAP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** close blast 2
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6). Push 2.
Hit: Confer **toppled**.
Shadow: Add 3 damage (1d6).

5. RIVER OF FILTH (D,E)

This room is divided by waist-high water: a wide iron grate on the north wall outpours a strong river of rancid sewage that runs south and then disappears over a ledge.

A. **Encounter**: 2 **Sickly Crocodiles**. Lounging anemically in the darkness on the far side of the river. Glowing yellow eyes, like the other wildlife of the cistern. Strong enough to swim through the river without difficulty, and famished.

B. **River of Filth**. Counts as **difficult terrain**. A commoner that ends their turn inside takes **1** damage just from the putrescence of the water, and must make a MIGHT | ATHLETICS check at the end of their turn or be swept over the falls by the swift current, landing on the grate below and taking **2d6** falling damage.

C. **Chest**. The heavy, iron-bound chest is locked, but it can be picked (14) or smashed open (16).

- bag of gems (value 3)
- sword (d8, melee, confer **unguarded 2).**
- chainmail (H,+2 AR, d8 AD).
- round shield (+2 AR, d6 AD).

D. **Corpse**. A dead rat catcher, half-devoured by the alligators.

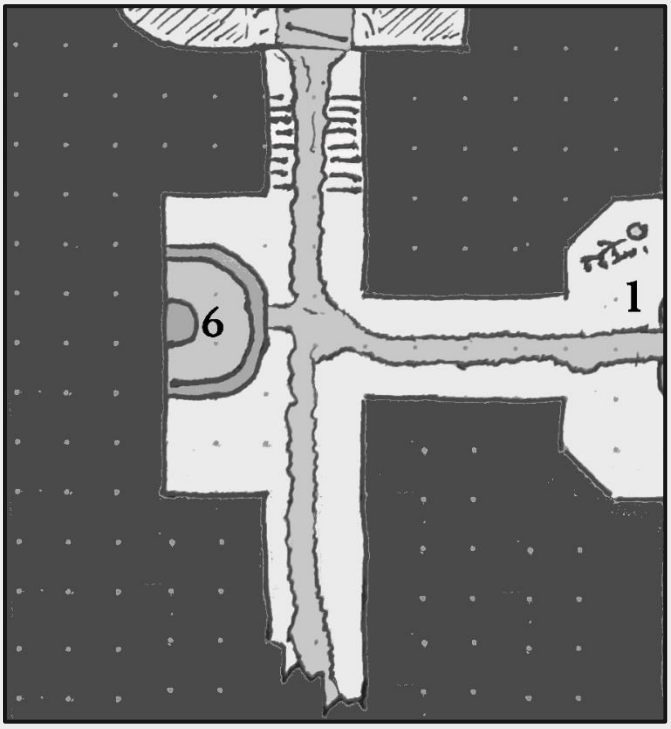
- rat-stick (d8, melee, two-handed, confer **bleeding 2,** deals 2 extra damage to rats)

E. **Sign: West.** A crack in the wall is big enough to fit an arm. It be smashed wide enough for a person to fit through, given enough effort (14| SLOW). Leads to **8**.

F. **Sign: South**. The rapid water tumbles down a steep slope, where most of it vanishes into an algae-covered iron grate. There's a metallic noise among the roaring water: A dead guardsman is slumped over, hidden by the water below.

- crude great helm (H, +2 AR, d8 AD).
- crude leather armor (L, +1 AR, d6 AD).
- bag of copper coins (1 value)

G. **Sign: North**. One of the iron bars has fallen away, creating a space just wide enough for someone to slip through, though the current is tremendously powerful. Something metal gleams in the darkness beyond.



RAT SWARM — TR 10

- **Harrier 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 15
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Swarm: This creature occupies a 2 x 2 area and can share space with other creatures. Its attacks target enemies that share a space with it. It suffers double damage from blasts, bursts, and paths that target more than one of its squares.

(L) **HUNDRED BITES** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: up to 4 creatures in swarm
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **afflicted 2**.

(M) **BURROW INTO CLOTHING** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature in swarm
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Hit: Confer **inaccurate 4**.

(M) **SWARM OVER** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature in swarm
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Hit: Add 3 damage (1d6). Confer **toppled 2**.

6. TUNNEL BLESSER'S ALTAR (E)

The western end of this room is dominated by an old fountain that has been dressed up as an altar somehow. Water overflows it and joins the stream down a huge pipe to the south. Two burning torches mounted on either side. There is incense burning on small stone plate on the edge of the fountain.

A. **Encounter: 3 Rat Swarms**. Hordes of yellow-eyed rats have bitten a robed figure to death and begin to carry him in an odd procession up the steps to the north, as if under a trance. They will ignore the party unless aggressed upon.

- **Tunnel Blesser Corpse**. If the party recovers the corpse, they find the dwarf's pouch contains:
  - potion of healing (recover 2d6 HP)
  - powder of crystallization (creates up to six obstacles in a close blast 3)

B. **Fountain**. The fountain is oddly clean, despite the dank environment. Drinking it will restore **1 HP** and cleanse a **plight**, but it can only affect a given commoner once. Three pale **cave salmon** that lazily circle in the water it. It would be AGILITY | NATURE to catch them (16 | DAUNTING).

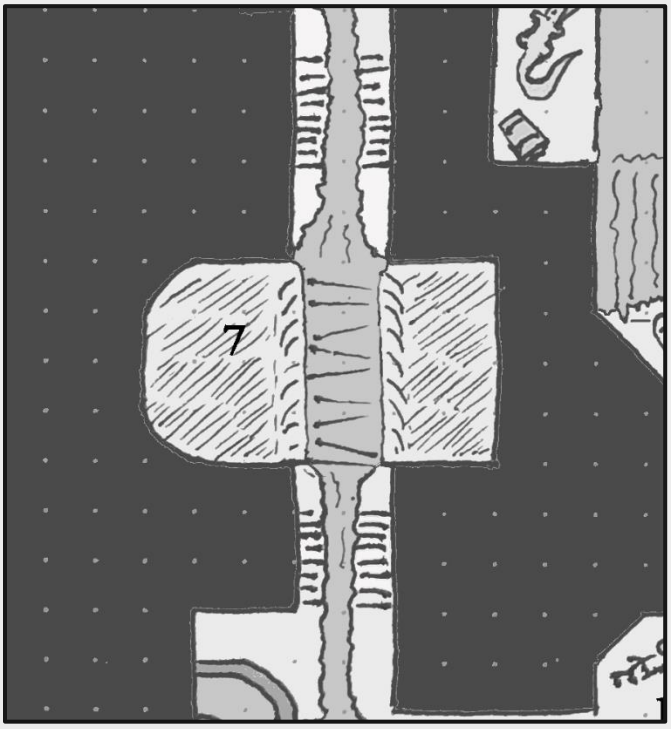
C. **Incense.** Only one coiled stem of this incense is burning, but it fills the room with a pleasant fragrance that repels the foul sewer odor. There is a small box next to it containing more (value 1 treasure).

D. **Torches.** The fountain is flanked by two torches, already burning. They can be removed from their sconces without trouble.

E. **Sign: North.** Dark water flows down the slick steps leading north. Above the babble of the water, you can make is the echoing squeak of bats ahead.

F. **Sign: South.** The water in the passage drifts southward into a large pipe that ends in a precipice, opening back into the harbor. It's a staggering drop to the bottom. Someone left their shortbow and smoking pipe here on a dry stone.

- shortbow (d8, missile 8, two-handed, confer **slow 4**).
- sewer dwarf pipe, packed with dried flakeleaf (can be enjoyed by one character to gain **fortified 2** as a lasting state).



7. OVERFLOWING BRIDGE (E)

The passage opens into a yawning chasm. A bridge with no railing spans a stone shaft that stretches upward and downward at least a hundred feet. Moonlight filters down from an iron grate high above. Fearful silhouettes flit past it, casting shadows over the scene.

A. **Encounter: 3 Sewer Bats**. It is the hunting hour for these creatures, and they will happily enjoy some commoner flesh if the opportunity arises.

B. **Overflowing Bridge.** Water pours of the sides of this bridge and down into the darkness below. It is **difficult terrain**, and a creature pushed over the side will fall 50 ft into the darkness, suffering **5d6** damage. A creature that manages to safely descend can find a **random magic item** among the guano and mud below.

C. **Rope.** A slick **rope** is knotted to an iron hook in the wall and trails down over the side of the precipice. There is a hook on the far end of the room as well.

D. **Sign: North.** The water splatters down more stone steps to the north, coming from somewhere in the darkness.

E. **Sign: South.** The remaining water flows steadily down a set of slick steps, where is glimmers in flickering torchlight.



SEWER BAT — TR 10

- **Harrier 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 16
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

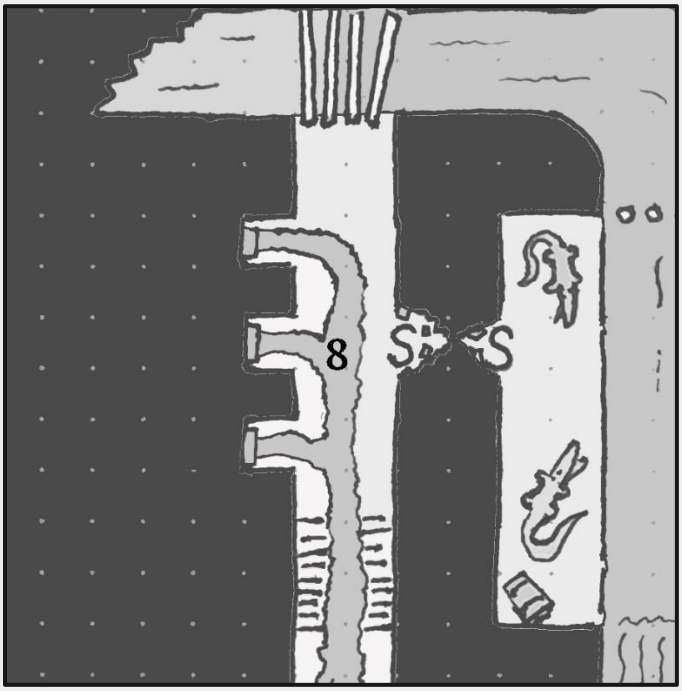
Flying: A bat can **move** ✦➤ at half speed to gain **airborne height** equal to the distance moved. It can glide down freely while it moves, losing 1 height for each square it travels.

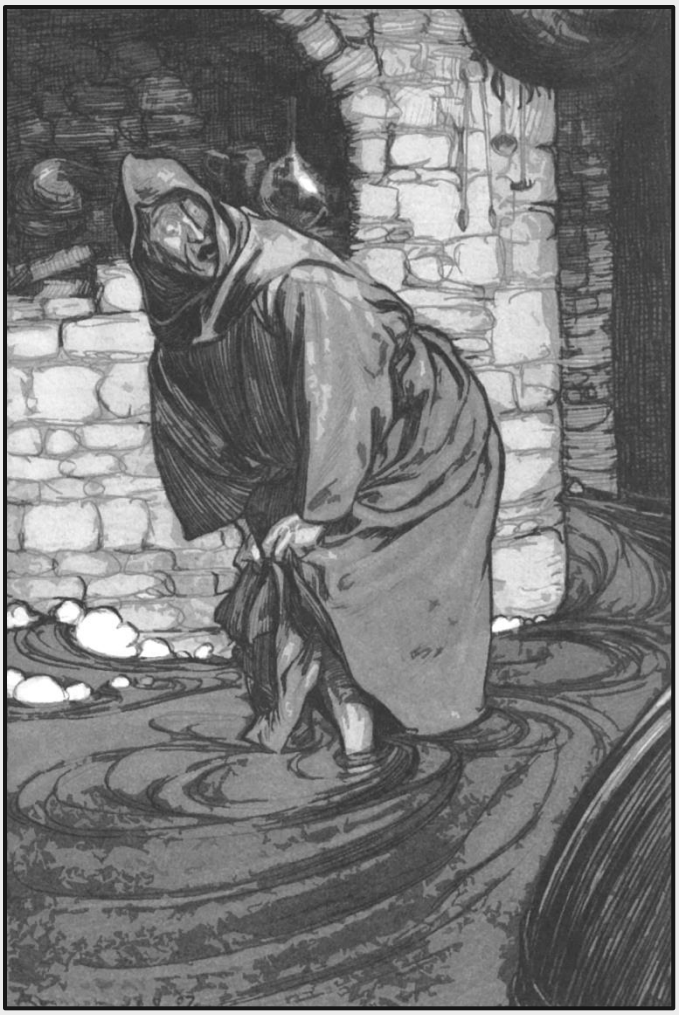
(L) **INFECTIOUS BITE** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **weak 4**.

(H) **FLY BY SCRATCH** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Start: Jump 4. Target one creature adjacent during the move.
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6). Push 2. If the target is in a mob, reduce the push amount by 1 for each other creature in the mob.

(M) **SONIC PULSE** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 4
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6). The target cannot take any actions on its next turn.







8. WESTERN PASSAGE (D)

This hallway features three alcoves, from which dark water flows and joins a stream heading southward and down some filth-coated steps. The right wall has collapsed partially, and there's a crack about the width of an arm into a large chamber east. North, a wooden planks crosses a river of swiftly moving sludge.

A. **Left-Most Pipe.** A dagger and unburnt candle is sitting atop south-most pipe mouth. Next to the objects, a still rat stares blankly with glowing yellow eyes.

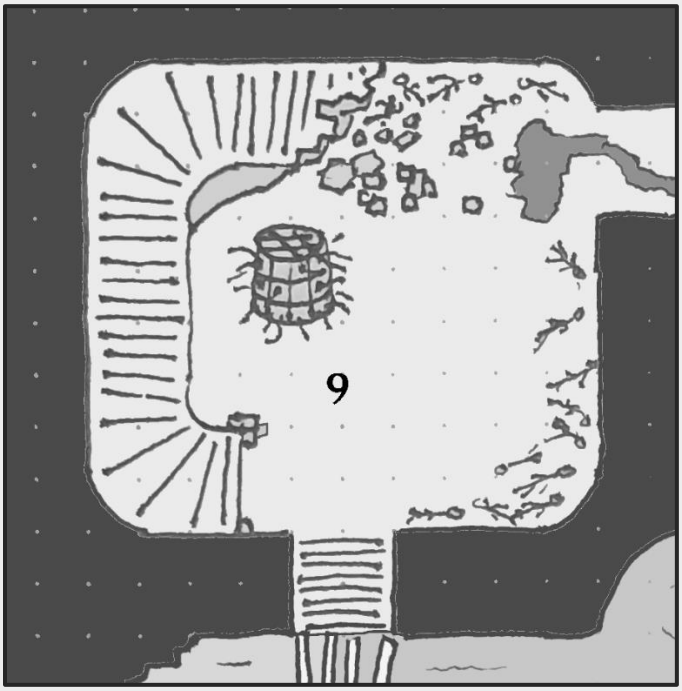
- ✦ dagger (1d4, melee/missile 4, confer **bleeding 4**)
- ✦ candle (emits light in a **burst 2**, **d6** depletion die).

B. **Middle Pipe.** A large, beautiful spider web is has been spun over the mouth to this pipe, above the water. Further inside, eight glowing yellow eyes twinkle in the darkness.

C. **Right-Most Pipe**. Just inside the mouth of the pipe, the **key to the echoing cistern** is hanging from a hook.

D. **Collapsed Wall.** A section of the eastern wall has collapsed, and there is a vertical crack wide enough to fit an arm. A roaring current can be heard in the darkness on the other side. A character that reaches through will be **snapped** by one of the sickly crocodiles (GUARD vs. 16). On a hit, they take **1d6** damage, and their arm is bitten off. The crack be smashed wide enough for a person to fit through, given enough effort (14 | SLOW). This, of course, will disturb the crocodiles. Leads to **5**.

E. **Sign: North.** Wooden planks lead across a river of dark sewer water. Beyond it, steps lead up. There is the smell of death beyond, far worse than any of the foul odors encountered thus far.



9. CRUMBLING STAIRWELL (D,E)

This large chamber looks like it once featured a large stone stair up to the surface, but it has long broken away. The smell of death is powerful here- corpses in various stages of decay are piled up along the walls. Near the center is a great iron cage stuffed with corpses, a bouquet of gray limbs and emaciated faces frozen in terror. Stairs go south, and a passage goes east.

A. **Encounter: Accursed Amalgam.** The amalgam hates life and is full of endless rage for those who possess it. It is always **hostile**.

B. **Detail Trap: Broken Stair.** There is a small chest sitting at the top of this stair, but crumbling stone steps look on the verge of total collapse.

- **Special:** Cannot be disarmed, but can be ascended carefully with AGILITY | ACROBATICS to reach the chest **(12 | COSTLY | HARMFUL).**
- **Effect:** The stair collapses, dealing **4d10** damage to each creature under it and **1d6** to each creature on top or within one square of it. The entire space is replaced with a mix of **obstacles** and **difficult terrain**.
- **Chest:** This iron box contains a bag of silver pieces (value 3) and a **random magic item**.

C. **Corpses.** The corpses piled around the edge of the room are **difficult terrain.** None of them have anything of value.

D. **Sign: East.** A pool of blood stems from the eastward tunnel. In the distance, an enchanting song can be heard. This way leads to the **echoing cistern (12)**, but also the exit!



ACCURSED AMALGAM — TR 20

- **Hellion Paragon 1**
- **HP:** 100
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 14
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 14
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Paragon: A paragon has more health than a normal creature of its role, and it takes two turns each round: one during the enemy phase, and one at the end of the round.

Large: A large creature occupies a 2 x 2 area. It blocks line of sight and can resist forced movement by half.

Wall Climbing: An amalgam can move at normal speed up walls and never needs to make a check to do so.

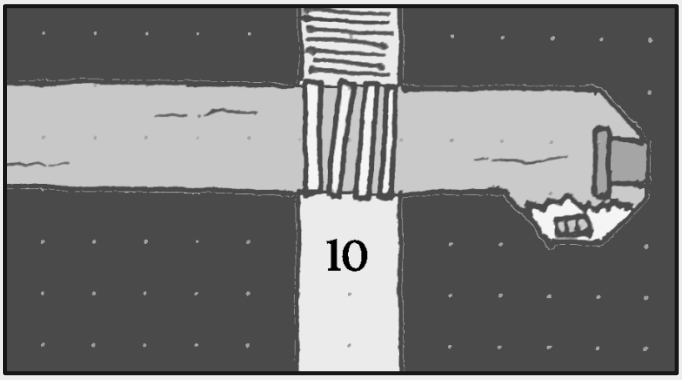
Grasping Arms: An amalgam can grapple multiple creatures at a time. A creature grappled by an amalgam suffers **1d8** damage at the start of its turn.

Embracing Counter: When an amalgam **counters** ➘ a melee attack, it can also confer **grappled 4** to the attacker.

(L) **RENDING CLUTCHES** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal **4** damage (1d8).
Shadow: Confer **grappled 4**. If the target is in a mob, the entire mob is collectively grappled.

(H) **HORRIFIC LEAP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Start: Jump 6 | **Area:** close burst 1
Base: Push 2. Confer **toppled.** If this attack targets a mob, the entire mob is pushed and **toppled**.
Hit: Deal **2** damage.

(M) **TEAR APART** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 grappled creature, or 1 creature in a grappled mob
Base: Deal 2d8 damage. The amalgam recovers HP equal to the damage dealt.
Hit: Add 1d8 damage. If the target is in a mob, the entire mob gains **terrified 4**. While affected, if the mob starts within INTENSITY squares of the amalgam, they must move until they are no longer within that many squares before taking any other actions.



10. SPLINTERING BRIDGE (D,T)

A few wooden planks have been lain over this stretch of the sewer channel, but the overflowing water has carried a couple of them away. It looks somewhat hazardous to cross.

A. **Room Trap: Rotten Planks. Hidden 3.** Close inspection will reveal that the planks are decaying, and that trying to cross them could spell misfortune.

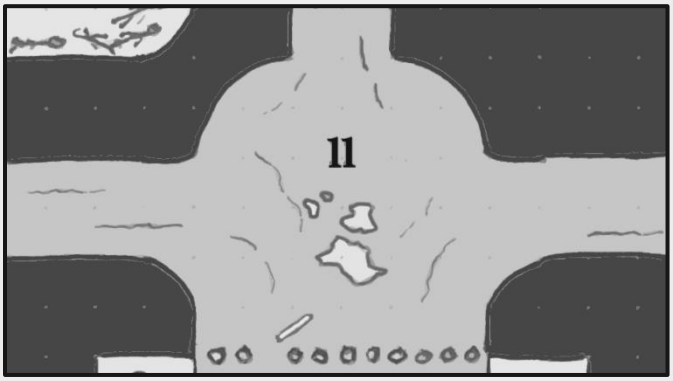
- **Disarm:** A character that successfully disarms this trap will find that by layering the planks over each other, they form a solid enough surface to cross, albeit one at a time. Even frail things have strength when put to the same purpose.
- **Trigger:** The first commoner that crosses without rearranging the planks must pass a simple check of **AGILITY | ACROBATICS** or fall into the water as the plans give way.
- **Effect:** On a failure, they suffer **1d4** damage and are swept to **11**. If that character was in a mob, they are separated from it until they are rescued.

B. **Pipe Mouth.** Water is flowing rapidly from a pipe mouth to the east. Beside it, there is a small rocky outcropping where some enterprising rebel has left a small, slime-covered wooden box of explosives.

- blasting bomb (deals 3d6 damage in a blast 3)
- shrapnel bomb (creates a field of sharp spikes that deals 4 terrain damage in a blast 3).

C. **Sign: North.** Stairs ascend, lit from the chamber above by a sickly greenish glow. The sound of a lovely voices echoes, urging you on.

D. **Sign: South.** A heavy iron door is covered moisture and warm to the touch.



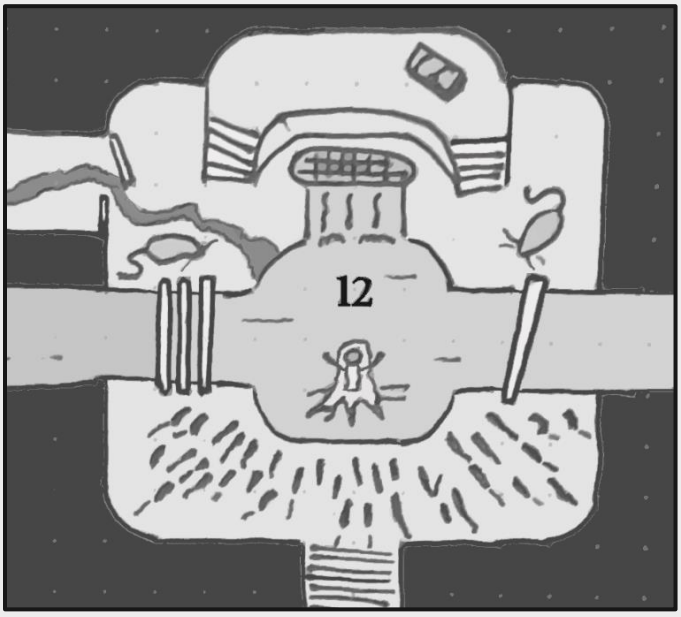
11. DESOLATE ROCKS (D)

There is no obvious way to reach this small pile of ruined stone at the convergence of the sewer ducts, but a character swept off by the current from one of the other rooms will find themselves clinging desperately to these slime-covered stones.

A. **Corpse**. A headless, rotting corpse has washed up on the rocks. An algae-coated scabbard on its back contains a greatsword, though a character would have to tangle with the slippery buckle to wrest it free (MIGHT | TINKERING VS. 14 | COSTLY).

- greatsword (d10, melee, two-handed, confer **unguarded 2**)

B. **Sign: South.** Massive iron bars run the length of the ceiling to the floor, filtering all manner of detritus from the water as it flows steadily south. One of them has broken away, leaving enough room for someone to squeeze through, though they would have to negotiate the mounting current (AGILITY | ATHLETICS VS 14 | HARMFUL). A character that fails is swept away by the **river of filth** (**5B**).



12. ECHOING CISTERN (E)

A beautiful woman sits at the center of a glowing green pool, filling this vaulted chamber with a sickly green radiance. Hundreds upon hundreds of rats - including two giant ones - look on with yellow eyes, enthralled by her song. This is a private concert, and trespassers here are interrupting the program. All eyes will turn on them.

A. **Encounter**: The Tainted Siren, 2 Whiptail Rats, 2 Rat Swarms. The siren can use her **aquatic** ability to swim below the surface; the cistern and water are **4** squares deep.

B. **West Planks.** The west planks are sturdy and dry. It is safe to cross them.

C. **Detail Trap: East Plank.** The east plank is splintering and may give out under too much weight. If the party unable to **explore** a space, they cannot discover a **detail trap** ahead of time, but they can still trigger it accidentally.

- **Effect**: Any creature larger than a normal rat must pass a simple check (AGILITY | ACROBATICS VS. 14) to reach the other side or be sent tumbling into the water. On a failure, they suffer **1d4** damage and gain the **sickly** plight, and are swept to **11**.

D. **Chest.** The siren's chest on the balcony above is filled with seawater and contains her greatest treasures.

- 1d8 assorted male skulls, one of which is wearing an antique helm (L,+1 AR, D8 AD).
- a silver mirror inlaid with sea-glass (value 3)
- waterlogged sheet music

E. **Sign: Northwest.** A trail of blood leads to the **crumbling stairwell (9)**, but also the exit!

THE TAINTED SIREN — TR 20

- **Sorcerer 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 12
- **Resist:** 16
- **Roll Bonus:** +4

Aquatic: This creature can swim and breathe underwater. It moves at full speed in water, and it can sacrifice movement points to gain that much **sunken** intensity, up to the depth of the water in squares.

(L) **DROWSE** ✦ SPELL ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **weary 4**.
Special: If the target cannot hear, the damage is reduced to **1**.

(H) **ENTHRALLING SONG** ✦ SPELL ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature | **Range**: 8
Base: The target makes a **weapon attack** against another adjacent creature of the siren's choice. If the target is in a mob, it attacks one of its mob-mates first.
Hit: The target also loses two **action points** on its next turn.
Special: A target that cannot hear cannot be targeted.

(M) **SLUMBER OF THE DEEP** ✦ SPELL ATTACK VS. RESIST
Area: 1 square | **Range:** 8
Base: Deal 1d4 damage.
Hit: Confer **slumbering 4**. On its turn, the affected creature can only make a single **prevail** check against this state.
Special: If the square is occupied by a mob, this affects all creatures in that mob. Any creature that cannot hear is unaffected.

SUNKEN

A sunken creature is either swimming underwater or tunneling just beneath the earth. The INTENSITY of this state represents how deep it is, so it is usually referred to as **depth**.

A sunken creature is protected by the substance it travels in, reducing all damage it takes by half. It can move through other creatures and obstacles and ignores difficult terrain, terrain damage, fields, and other effects on the surface.

After damaging a **sunken** creature, a character can use **prevail** ✦➤ to try to force it out of the water. On a success, the creature is pulled to the surface, losing this state and gaining **prone.**

When a character **drags**, **pulls**, or **sweeps** a sunken creature, they can choose to remove **depth** equal to the squares of the forced movement. If this reduces the **intensity** to zero, the creature is wrenched to the surface and becomes **toppled** automatically.

LESSER WHIPTAIL RAT	TR 10

- **Enforcer 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 12
- **Resist:** 14
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Puny: This creature has half the normal hit points for its level.

(L) **FROTHING CHOMP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature
Hit: Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Shadow: Push 2. Sunder 1 armor die.

(H) **WHIPTAIL GRAB** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 3
Base: Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Hit: Pull 2. Confer **grappled 4**. Each time a creature fails to escape the grapple, the grappled creature takes **intensity** damage. If the target is in a mob, the entire mob is unable to move until the creature is freed.

(M) **WHIPTAIL SQUEEZE** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 grappled creature | **Range:** 1
Base: Sunder 1 armor die. Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Hit: Add 9 damage (2d8).

RAT SWARM	TR 10

- **Harrier 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 15
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Swarm: This creature occupies a 2 x 2 area and can share space with other creatures. Its attacks target all enemies that share a space with it. It suffers double damage from blasts, bursts, and paths that target more than one of its squares.

(L) **HUNDRED BITES** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: all creatures in swarm
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **afflicted 2**.

(H) **SWARM OVER** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature in swarm
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Hit: Add 3 damage (1d6). Confer **toppled 2**.

(M) **BURROW INTO CLOTHING** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature in swarm
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6)
Hit: The target loses two action points on its next turn.

ESCAPE!

If the commoners follow the trail of blood out of either the **crumbling stairwell** or the **echoing cistern**, they have the option to leave the dungeon and end the First Day.

Following the blood trail north will lead them to a round well-bottom where the blood trickles down from the surface above. A rusted iron ladder leads up to the streets. They will find themselves in a small borough called Blood's End, so named because the runoff from nearby Retribution Square winds its way down the street and into the sewer here. The entrance they emerge from is an ugly pit squarely in the center of a cul-de-sac of ramshackle wooden houses and black stone buildings.

THE CAMPAIGN

From here, it's up to you how to tie this event to your campaign. Perhaps the commoners become new members of hapless community of Blood's End, and as the weeks pass, they find themselves changed by their experience in the cistern and ready to pursue trespassing as a full-time profession. They dabble in new skills and martial crafts in this time, preparing themselves for a foray into another place of peril.

If you adapted this dungeon to be a ruin or even a natural cavern, perhaps their arrival on the surface will reveal to them that there is no more city on the cliffs above, and they now find themselves in the wilderness of a strange new continent.

Whatever you choose to do, it's recommended to resolve a little time-skip here before the true party is realized and the trespassers come together. You can have a session zero now as a break between the First Day and the start of the campaign, describing the characters' new circumstances and inviting each player to describe their activities during this time and how their character decided upon their **calling** and first **craft**. When the party feels ready, it's time to proceed onward with the campaign!

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

A dungeon's **alarm** starts at **0**. After every dungeon round, you raise the **alarm** by **+1**, then roll a **d10**. If the result is less than or equal to the current alarm, the party is encountered by roaming pack of creature

When a random encounter starts, you launch into the random encounter procedure outlined below. Roll a **d6** to determine the creatures encountered, roll 2d6 x 5 to determine the total threat rating, then follow the rest of the procedure described here. Statblocks are at the end of the document.

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS

D4

1. **Rats**
2. **Oozes**
3. **Frogs**
4. **Thieves**

SURPRISE

At the start of an encounter, the party needs to make a **surprise check** to find out which group spots the other first. If the encounter interrupts their exploration, this is made instead of the party's usual **explore** check.

A **surprise check** is a group check of AGILITY | STEALTH in the dungeon. This check is made against the dungeon's **hostility target number**. On a success, the party get to choose an approach. On a failure, the other group does.

AMBUSHES

If the entire party succeed on their **surprise check**, they catch the others unaware. They may choose the **ambush** approach in addition to the normal options. If the entire party fails, the other group may choose to **ambush**. A group that decides to ambush initiates combat, and their opponents skip their turns on the first round of combat.

REACTION

If the group's disposition is uncertain, you can roll **2d6** on the table below, adding **+1** if the others are fellow trespassers. Their attitude limits what approach they might take, should they get to choose one.

REACTIONS

2D6	ATTITUDE	APPROACHES
1 - 5	**Hostile**	Ambush, Fight
6 - 7	**Wary**	Ambush, Fight, Withdraw
8 - 9	**Curious**	Greet, Warn, Withdraw
10 - 12	**Friendly**	Greet, Warn

DISTANCE

If you are uncertain about the distance between the two groups, you can roll one or more **d6s** based on the dimensions of the space. The result is the number of squares between the party and the others encountered.

- **1d6** for a cramped interior space
- **3d6** for an open interior space
- **5d6** (or more) for an exterior space

APPROACH

Lastly, the winner of the surprise check gets to choose an approach: **ambush**, **fight**, **greet**, **warn,** or **withdraw**. If the players win, the current party leader should make this decision. Their choice decides how the encounter proceeds.

AMBUSH

The party can only choose this approach if the others are **surprised**, and vice versa. The group that takes this approach initiates combat, and the opposing side skip their turns on the first round of combat.

FIGHT

The group initiates combat, boldly advancing with no effort to disguise their intentions. A combat encounter begins, and both sides take their turns as normal in the first round.

GREET

The group emerges peacefully with lowered weapons and waits to see what the other group will do. The other side may choose any approach, including an **ambush**. If the party takes this approach, it improves the attitude of **wary** or **curious** groups by one step, but hostile groups will always use the opportunity to **ambush**.

WARN

A group that decides to warn abdicates choice. They make their presence known and may issue threats or demands, but they hold action to see how the others will respond; the others may choose an approach, but they cannot **ambush**.

WITHDRAW

The group retreats from the area to their last place of relative safety. The party may lose some time or supplies, depending on the circumstance. If the party takes this approach, the Judge decides whether the others choose to give chase based on their reaction check. If the others are **surprised**, they do not notice the party and cannot pursue them. If the party encounters creatures in a dungeon and withdraws, they can **explore** in a different direction without spending another action.

RATS

LESSER WHIPTAIL RAT — TR 10

- **Enforcer 1**
- **HP:** 40
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 12
- **Resist:** 14
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

(L) **FROTHING CHOMP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature
Hit: Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Shadow: Push 2. Sunder 1 armor die.

(H) **WHIPTAIL GRAB** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 3
Base: Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Hit: Pull 2. Confer **grappled 4**. Each time a creature fails to escape the grapple, the grappled creature takes **intensity** damage. If the target is in a mob, the entire mob is unable to move until the creature is freed.

LESSER SPINY RAT — TR 10

- **Harrier 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 16
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Spiny Burst: On defeat, a spiny rat creates a field of difficult terrain in its own square and each square around it. It deals 1 terrain damage.

(L) **QUICK BITE** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6). The spiny rat can **jump 3**.
Shadow: Confer **bleeding 2**.

(H) **SPINE-TAIL SHOT** ✦ MISSILE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 6
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Hit: Confer **bleeding 4**.
Shadow: Push 2. Confer **toppled**.

OOZES

LESSER ACIDIC OOZE — TR 10

- **Stalker 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 14
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +4

Sluggish: This creature cannot spend extra movement points when it moves.

Dissolve Weapons: After hitting an acidic ooze, the attacker must make a **depletion check** for their weapon. Magic weapons are unaffected.

Dissolve Armor: Any creature that spends an armor die to reduce damage from this creature's attack must make a **depletion check** for that armor piece.

(L) **CAUSTIC SLAP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 4 damage (1d8).
Shadow: Sunder 1 armor die. The defender must make a **depletion check** for that armor piece.

(H) **ACIDIC GLOBULE** ✦ INNATE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Area: 1 square | **Range:** 6
Base: Deal 4 damage (1d8). Create a **field** of bubbling acid that deals **1 terrain damage**.
Hit: Confer **frail 2**.

LESSER TOXIC OOZE — TR 10

- **Enforcer 1**
- **HP:** 40
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Sluggish: This creature cannot spend extra movement points when it moves.

Sickening Aura: A creature that starts its turn adjacent to this one loses one action point immediately.

(L) **SICKLY SLAP** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 4 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **afflicted 1**.

(H) **FOUL SPLATTER** ✦ INNATE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Area: 1 adjacent square
Base: Confer **afflicted 1**. Create a field of difficult terrain.
Hit: Confer **afflicted 2** instead.

FROGS

LESSER DART FROG — TR 10

- **Archer 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 14
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 14
- **Roll Bonus:** +4

(L) **GULLET DART** ✦ VERSATILE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 8
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **afflicted 1**.

(H) **DOUBLE DART** ✦ MISSILE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Start: Make the target twice against the same or different targets within range.
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 8
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **afflicted 1**.

LESSER MOON FROG — TR 10

- **Sorcerer 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 16
- **Guard:** 12
- **Resist:** 16
- **Roll Bonus:** +4

Aberrant Mind: This creature is immune to **delirious**.
Dizzying Gaze: Aura in a burst 4. Whenever an attack made inside incurs a **shadow** against this creature, the attacker gains **delirious 1**.

(L) **SILVER TONGUE** ✦ VERSATILE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 4
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **weary 2**.

(H) **MOONSTRUCK GAZE** ✦ SPELL ATTACK VS. RESIST
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 6
Hit: Deal 1d6 damage. Confer **delirious 2**.

THIEVES

LESSER CUTPURSE — TR 10

- **Harrier 1**
- **HP:** 30
- **Speed:** 6
- **Initiative:** 16
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

Evading Strike: After this creature **counters** ⮟, it can **jump** up to half its speed.

(L) **KNIFE** ✦ VERSATILE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 4
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **bleeding 1**.

(H) **THROWING KNIVES** ✦ MISSILE ATTACK VS. RESIST
Start: Make the attack two times against the same or different creatures in range.
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 4
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **bleeding 1**.

(M) **GUT-SPILLER** ✦ MELEE ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | range 1
Base: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Hit: Add 7 damage (2d6).

LESSER STRONGARM THIEF — TR 10

- **Enforcer 1**
- **HP:** 40
- **Speed:** 5
- **Initiative:** 12
- **Accuracy:** 14
- **Guard:** 14
- **Resist:** 12
- **Roll Bonus:** +2

(L) **GRAB** ✦ UNARMED ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 3 damage (1d6).
Shadow: Confer **grappled 4**.

(H) **KNOCKOUT** ✦ UNARMED ATTACK VS. GUARD
Target: 1 creature
Base: Deal 7 damage (2d6).
Hit: Push 4. Confer **toppled**.

(M) **STRONGARM FRENZY** ✦ UNARMED ATTACK VS. GUARD
Start: Make the attack two times against the same or different creatures in range.
Target: 1 creature | **Range:** 1
Hit: Deal 7 damage (2d6).
Shadow: Confer **frail 2**.